

University Centre Abdelhafid Boussouf E-learning Centre



English – Level2

– Lesson 03 –

Forms of Phrases

Pedagogical Staff

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Students Concerned- Semester 3

<i>Institute</i>	<i>Department</i>	<i>Year</i>	<i>Speciality</i>
Letters and Languages	• Foreign Languages	Licentiate 2	French
Science and Technology	• Mathematics and Computer Science • Technical Science	Licentiate 2	-MI -ST
Economic Science	• Economic Science • Commercial Science • Management Science	Licentiate 2	All specialties

Objectives of the Lesson:

This lesson has been tailored to fulfill a number of objectives; the following are rated to be the most essential of them all. It will, therefore, empower students:

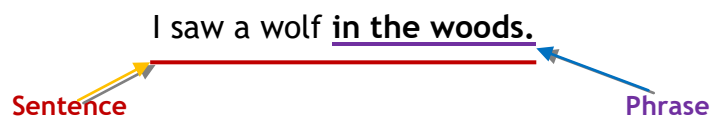
- To recognize a phrase when coming across one.
- To be aware of the different kinds of phrases.
- To be able to differentiate between a phrase and a clause.

1. WHAT IS A PHRASE?

Phrases are one of the most important grammatical units of English grammar. A **phrase** is a small group of words which has no **finite verb** or **clause** in it. **Phrases** are used to **build clauses** and **strengthen** the **meaning** of **sentences**; therefore, **phrases** are usually present within a **clause** or a **sentence**.

Phrases come in several forms, namely **noun phrases**, **verb phrases**, **adjective phrases**, **adverb phrases**, and **prepositional phrases**.

Example:



Note¹: Unlike a clause, a phrase must not have a **finite verb**.

Note²: A **finite verb** is a **single** (one) **word verb** that acts as the **main verb** in a sentence; it shows **agreement** with the **subject**. Usually, it has a present or a past tense.

2. FORMS OF PHRASES

1. NOUN PHRASE

Generally, a **noun phrase** (also known as **nominal phrase**) can be a **noun** (school, house, book...) or a **pronoun** (I, you, they...). **Noun phrases** can also include **premodifiers** that come before the noun. It is possible to join two noun phrases with (**and**) or (**or**) as well as place **one noun phrase after another**.

Note: *Premodifiers* include *determiners* (these, that...) *quantifiers* (all, both...) *numbers* (one, four...), *adjectives* (new, tall...)

Examples:

The winner and the loser got out of the court.

Noun phrase 1 Noun phrase 2

My neighbor, Mr. Smith, is a firefighter.

Noun phrase 1 Noun phrase 2

2. VERB PHRASE

A **verb phrase** must include at least one **verb**, often a **verb phrase** is composed of a **main verb** (such as: come, walk, speak) and an **assisting verb** (an **auxiliary verb**, such as *might, are, will*).

Examples:

The student is writing an essay.

Verb phrase

I can smell the flowers.

Verb phrase

3. ADJECTIVE PHRASE

An **adjective phrase** is a small group of words that includes an **adjective**. Sometimes, an **adjective phrase** is joined by an **adverb of degree** (*very, too, extremely, enough...*). The adjective of an **adjective phrase** can be at the **start, middle or the end of the phrase**.

Examples:

The library is very quiet.

Adjective phrase

She is a fairly elegant lady.

Adjective phrase

4. ADVERB PHRASE

An **adverb phrase** (also known as adverbial phrase) is a group of words functioning as an **adverb** in a sentence. **Adverb phrases** are commonly used to **modify verbs**. An **adverb phrase** must include an adverb. Sometimes **adverb phrases** come with an **adverb of degree**.

Examples:

We have been studying since 8 am.

Adverb phrase

I swim quite regularly.

Adverb phrase

5. PREPOSITIONAL PHRASE

A **prepositional phrase** consists of a **preposition** (to, of, from, before, in, over, during...) and an **object** (a noun or pronoun). **Prepositional phrases** modify verbs or nouns.

Examples:

I arrived in time.

Prepositional phrase

She wears tops with colorful designs

Prepositional phrase

Let's Practice!

Choose phrases in the following sentences, and then identify their kinds.

1. The sun sets in the west.
2. I will be going to college next week.
3. You can have my book *whenever you want*.
4. This is the market where I shop.
5. Ann has brilliant ideas.
6. The teacher was really *bored* with the presentation.

REFERENCES

- Eastwood, John. Oxford Guide to English Grammar. Oxford, Oxford University Press, 1994.
- Raimes, Ann. Grammar *Trouble spots*. A Guide for Student Writers. Cambridge, Cambridge University Press, 2004.